10.1 INTRODUCTION

Communication is the exchange of information, thoughts and emotions among people using speech or other means. Therapeutic practice involves the oral communication of public health officials and nurses on the one hand and the patient or his relatives on the other. It is a two way process.

Communication is a vital element in Nursing in all areas of activity and in all its interventions such as prevention, treatment, therapy, rehabilitation, education and health promotion.

Communication leads to community, that is, to understanding, intimacy and mutual valuing.

- Rollo May

10.2 DEFINITION

Communication can be defined as a transaction and message creation. The entire process occurs in a context consisting of physical space, cultural and social values and psychological conditions

A process by which information is exchanged between individuals through a common system of symbols, signs, or behaviour also exchange of information

Communication is a skill that you can learn. It's like riding a bicycle or typing. It you're willing to work at it, you can rapidly improve the quality of every part of your life.

- Brian Tracy

Communication is the art of being understood.

- Peter Ustinov

10.3 COMMUNICATION PROCESS

Communication is a process of exchanging information, ideas, thoughts, and emotions through speech, signals, writing, and behaviour.

Let's put all these components together to build a model of the communication process:

1. A sender encodes information
2. The sender selects a channel of communication by which to send the message
3. The receiver receives the message
4. The receiver decodes the message
5. The receiver may provide feedback to the sender

10.3.1 Elements of Communication-

- ❖ Source of communication
- ❖ Receiver
- ❖ Sensory receptor
- ❖ Message carriers
- ❖ Messages
- ❖ Responses
- ❖ Feedback
- ❖ Situation or context

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